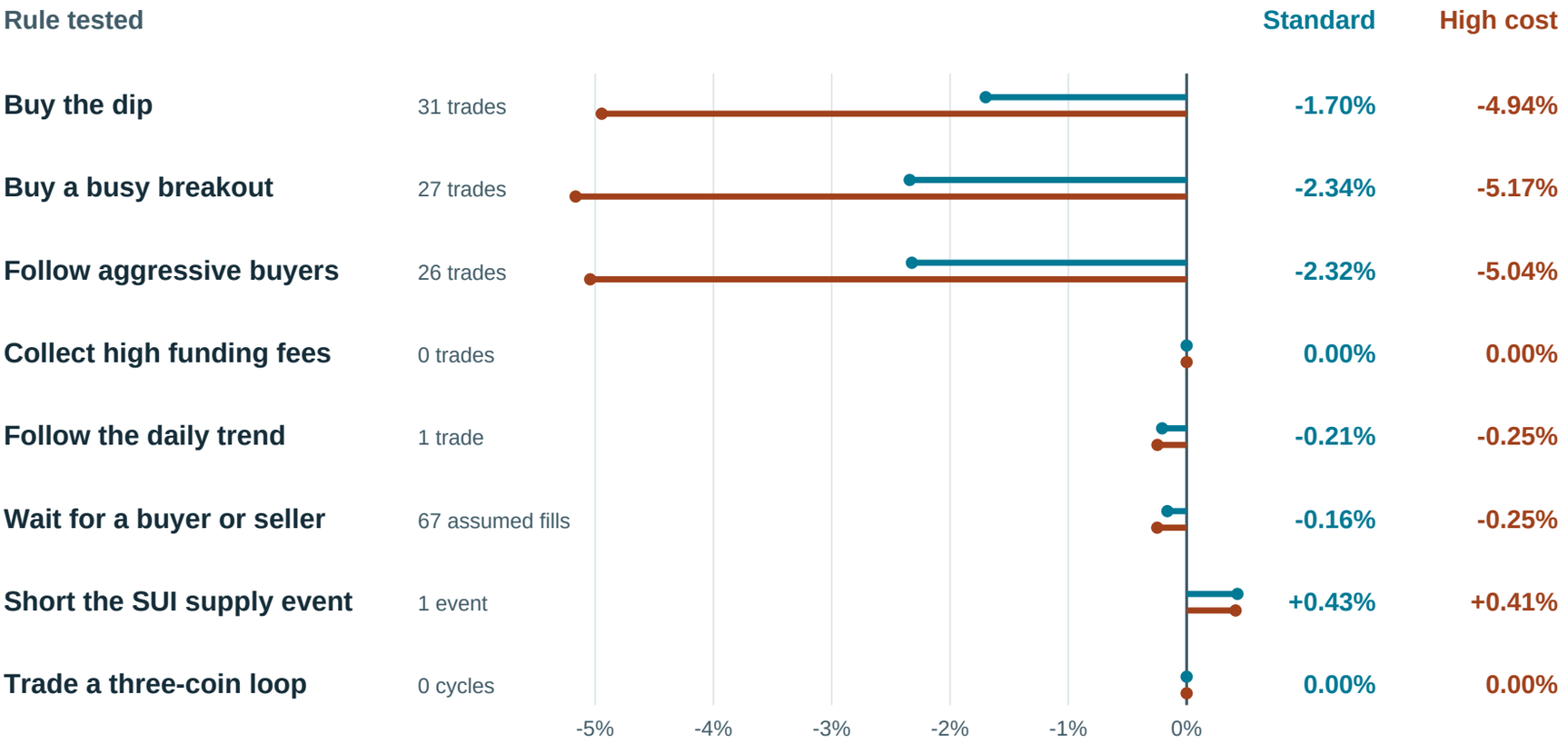
# Eight trading ideas tested with paper money

Five lost money after costs. Two never traded. One made a small gain on a single event. None has shown it can earn repeatable profits.

We wrote down each rule in advance and waited for new prices. The computer estimated whether an order could trade at a later quoted price and size. No real money changed hands. “High cost” means the same idea faced tougher assumptions about fees and the price it could get.

## How much each paper wallet gained or lost

Percent of the starting wallet, after modeled trading costs




Each idea had its own wallet. The first three started with 10,000 USDT each. The others started with 1,000.

Trend and patient orders include estimated sale values for small leftovers. SUI had one event. Data through Nov 10, 2026.

# What the experiments taught us

## A gain can disappear before you finish trading.

In a short check of three-coin exchange loops, the biggest apparent gain was about 5 cents per 100 USDT. Standard fees and slippage took about 42 cents to get around the loop. The forward wallet completed zero cycles.

## A rule can lose less than the market and still lose money.

The daily trend rule held a coin only while its price met the trend test. On a 1,000 USDT wallet, it lost 2.07 at standard costs. Holding all five coins through the comparison lost 63.88. Keeping the cash would have held its value in USDT.

## A good single trade still leaves the main question open.

The lab bet that SUI would fall around a scheduled token release. Its one closed paper trade earned 4.29 USDT after standard costs and 4.14 under higher costs. We could not verify whether recipients sold. The rule requires ten independent events before considering promotion.

## Replaying the past gives a different kind of evidence.

One earlier price-following rule made 42.55% before costs over a two-year historical replay. Its return fell to 13.42% under standard costs and became a loss of 18.13% under higher costs. These were the same modeled positions. They are separate from the eight forward wallets.

## What earns a second look

A complete first test, independent review and another future test with the same rules. A profitable week or a promising story alone leaves too much room for luck.

Sources: Nov 10 wallet review · Nov 9 retirement · Oct 22 conversion check · Sep 23 MACD replay (2026).